

National Symbols

*The **National Flag (Tricolour)** is rectangular in shape and consists of three colours. *The ratio of the length of the flag to its width is **3:2**. *The colour of the top band is **deep saffron (symbol of strength and courage)**, the middle band is **white (symbol of peace and truth)** and the bottom is **Dark green (symbol of fertility, growth and auspiciousness of the land)**. *In the centre of the white band is a **navy blue wheel** which represents the chakra. It has **24 spokes**, and its design is that of the wheel, which appears on the **abacus of the Sarnath lion capital of Ashoka**. *It is the **symbol of Justice**. *The National flag was designed by **Pingali Venkayya**. *The present design of the national flag was adopted by the constituent assembly on **22 July, 1947**. *The description of the importance of three colours and a wheel (chakra) in our national flag by Dr. S. Radhakrishnan is mentioned in the Flag code of India.

*The **state emblem** is an adoption from the **Sarnath lion capital of Ashoka**. *It was adopted by the Government of India on **26 January, 1950**. *The words '**Satyameva Jayate**' from **Mundaka Upanishad** are inscribed at the bottom in the Devnagri script. *The National Anthem of India '**Jana Gana Mana.....**' was officially adopted by the constituent assembly on 24th January, 1950. *It was first sung on **27th December, 1911** at the Calcutta session of the Indian National Congress (chairman- Pt. Bishan Narayan Dhar). *It was authored by Rabindra Nath Tagore. The Playing time of the full version is approximately 52 seconds. *The song '**Vande Mataram**' was adopted as the national song by the constituent assembly on **24 January, 1950**. It is taken from the novel "Anand Math" authored by Bankimchandra Chatterjee. *It was first sung at the 1896 session of the Indian National Congress (Chairman- Rahimtulla Sayani).

*The **National Calendar** Based on the Saka era (Chaitra as its first month and Falgun as the last) was adopted on 22nd March, 1957 along with the Gregorian Calendar. Generally, the month of Chaitra begins on 22 March, but in the leap years, it begins on 21 March.

*The **National Flower** of India is the **Lotus** (Nelumbo Nucifera Gaertn). The National fruit is **Mango** (Magnifera Indica). *The National tree is the **Banyan tree** (Ficus benyhalensis). *While the government has clearly stated in the Rajya Sabha that no notification has been issued regarding India having a National

flower, National fruit and national tree. *The National Animal is the magnificent **Tiger** (Panthera tigris). *The National Bird is the **Indian Peacock** (Pavo Cristatus). *The National Aquatic animal is the mammal **Ganges River Dolphin** (Platanista Gangetica).

*The river Ganga was declared the national river by the government of India in the year 2008. *The Government of India declared the Independence Day (15 August), Republic Day (26 January) and Birth Anniversary of Gandhi (2 October) as the **National Days**.

1. In which year was 'Jana Gana Mana' adopted as the National Anthem of India?

- | | |
|----------|----------|
| (a) 1948 | (b) 1949 |
| (c) 1950 | (d) 1951 |

R.A.S./R.T.S. (Pre) 1996

Ans. (c)

The Constituent Assembly accepted 'Jana Gana Mana' as the National Anthem of India on 24 January, 1950. A formal rendition of the national anthem takes fifty-two seconds.

2. When the Hindi version of National Anthem Jana-Gana-Mana was adopted by the Constituent Assembly of India?

- | |
|-----------------------|
| (a) 26 November, 1949 |
| (b) 24 January, 1950 |
| (c) 17 November, 1947 |
| (d) 9 December, 1946 |

Uttarakhand P.C.S. (Pre) 2021

Ans. (b)

The song Jana-Gana-Mana, composed originally in Bengali by Rabindranath Tagore, was adopted in its Hindi version by the constituent Assembly as the National Anthem of India on 24 January 1950. It was first sung on 27th December, 1911 at the Calcutta session of Indian National Congress.

3. A complete or formal rendition of national anthem takes-

- | | |
|----------------|----------------|
| (a) 50 seconds | (b) 45 seconds |
| (c) 52 seconds | (d) 55 seconds |

Jharkhand P.C.S. (Pre) 2011

Ans. (c)

'Jan Gana Mana' is the National Anthem of India, and its formal rendition takes 52 seconds while a shortened version consisting of the first and the last line takes 20 seconds to play.

4. The state emblem was adopted by Govt. of India on -
 (a) 15th August, 1948 (b) 2nd October, 1947
 (c) 26th January, 1948 (d) 26th January, 1950

M.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 1999

Ans. (d)

The State Emblem which is extracted from the Ashoka pillar at Sarnath (Varanasi) was adopted by the Government of India on 26 January, 1950.

5. When did the Constituent Assembly adopt the National Flag?

- (a) 22 July, 1947 (b) 23 July, 1947
 (c) 25 July, 1947 (d) 15 August, 1947

U.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 1990

Ans. (a)

The National Flag of India was adopted during the fourth session of the Constituent Assembly on 22 July, 1947.

6. Consider the following statements:

1. The design of the National Flag was adopted by the Constituent Assembly of India on 22nd July, 1947
2. The wheel in National Flag has 21 spokes
3. The ratio of the width of the National Flag to its length is 3 : 4

Which of the above statements is/are correct ?

- (a) 1 and 2 (b) 1 only
 (c) 2 and 3 (d) 2 only

U.P.P.C.S. (Mains) 2004

Ans. (b)

The design of the National Flag was adopted by the Constituent Assembly on 22 July, 1947. Therefore, statement 1 is correct. There are 24 spokes in the wheel and width to length ratio is 2:3, So, statements 2 and 3 are wrong.

7. Indian National Flag was adopted by the Constituent Assembly on which date ?

- (a) 26 November 1950 (b) 24 January 1950
 (c) 26 January 1950 (d) 22 July 1947

70th B.P.S.C. Pre-2024

Ans. (d)

The Constituent Assembly of India adopted the National Flag of India on 22nd July 1947. The national flag has 24 spokes in the wheel (Ashoka Chakra) in the centre, and the proportion of the length to the width of the flag is 3:2.

8. On which of the following dates, Constituent Assembly of India adopted the National Flag?

- (a) 22 January, 1950
 (b) 24 January, 1950

(c) 22 July, 1947

(d) 22 July, 1948

U.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 2020

Ans. (c)

The National Flag is rectangular and consists of three colours. The ratio of the length of the Flag to its width is 3:2. The constituent assembly adopted the National Flag's present design on 22nd July, 1947.

9. On which day the design of the National flag of India was adopted?

- (a) June 10, 1947 (b) July 22, 1947
 (c) August 15, 1947 (d) January 26, 1947

Jharkhand P.C.S. (Pre) 2021

Ans. (b)

See the explanation of the above question.

10. Consider the following statements in respect of the National Flag of India according to the Flag Code of India, 2002:

Statement-I :

One of the standard sizes of the National Flag of India is 600 mm × 400 mm.

Statement-II :

The ratio of the length to the height (width) of the Flag shall be 3:2.

Which one of the following is correct in respect of the above statements?

- (a) Both Statement-I and Statement-II are correct and Statement-II is the correct explanation for Statement-I
 (b) Both Statement-I and Statement-II are correct and Statement-II is not the correct explanation for Statement-I
 (c) Statement-I is correct but Statement-II is incorrect
 (d) Statement-I is incorrect but Statement-II is correct

I.A.S. (Pre.) 2023

Ans. (d)

The Flag Code of India 2002 allowed the unrestricted display of the Tricolour as long as the honour and dignity of the flag were being respected. It takes effect from January 26, 2002. For the sake of convenience, it is divided into three parts - 1. General description of the tricolour, 2. Rules on display of the flag by public and private bodies and educational institutions, 3. Rules for the display of the flag by governments and government bodies. According to the

provision of the code, the National Flag shall be rectangular in shape and the ratio of the length to the height (width) of the Flag shall be 3:2. The standard sizes of the National Flag shall be as follows :

Flag Size No.	Dimensions in mm
1	6300 × 4200
2	3600 × 2400
3	2700 × 1800
4	1800 × 1200
5	1350 × 900
6	900 × 600
7	450 × 300
8	225 × 150
9	150 × 100

Hence, statement I is incorrect but statement II is correct.

11. The total number of spokes in the National Flag of India is –

- (a) 20 (b) 24
(c) 26 (d) 30

Uttarakhand Lower Sub. (Pre) 2010

Ans. (b)

See the explanation of the above question.

12. India's National Animal is –

- (a) Deer (b) Elephant
(c) Tiger (d) Lion

U.P.R.O./A.R.O (Mains) 2014

Uttarakhand U.D.A./L.D.A (Pre) 2007

Ans. (c)

The Tiger (*Panthera Tigris* Linnaeus) is the national animal of India. To improve the decreasing population and to protect tigers, the Tiger Conservation Project was started in April 1973.

13. Which is the National Flower of India?

- (a) Sunflower
(b) Lotus
(c) Rose
(d) Marigold

Chhattisgarh P.C.S. (Pre) 2005

Ans. (b)

Lotus is the national flower of India and is the emblem of Indian Culture. Its scientific name is 'Nelumbo Nucifera'.

14. National Bird of India is-

- (a) Cuckoo (b) Swan
(c) Peacock (d) Pigeon

Uttarakhand U.D.A./L.D.A (Pre) 2003

Uttarakhand U.D.A./L.D.A (Pre) 2007

Ans. (c)

The national bird of India is Peacock. Its scientific name is *Pavo Cristatus*. It is notable that Banyan is the national tree, Mango is the national fruit, 'Satyamev Jayte' is the national motto taken from Mundaka Upanishad and inscribed in the script at the base of the National Emblem which has been adopted from the Lion Capital of Ashoka erected at Sarnath, Varanasi. The Ganges River Dolphin is the national aquatic animal of India.

15. What does the wheel on the 'Indian National Flag' symbolize?

- (a) Freedom (b) Justice
(c) Equality (d) Brotherhood

Uttarakhand P.C.S. (Pre) 2005

Ans. (b)

The wheel on a white strip of National Flag having 24 spokes is adopted from Ashok Chakra, which is a depiction of Dharmachakra represented by 24 spokes. It symbolizes the wheel of Law. So, Justice is the correct Answer.

16. With reference to the National Calendar, which of the statements is/are correct?

- The National Calendar of India is based on Vikram Era.
- The National Calendar is adopted from January 26, 1950.

Select the correct answer using the codes given below:

- (a) 1 only
(b) 2 only
(c) Both 1 and 2
(d) Neither 1 nor 2

U.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 2019

Ans. (d)

The National Calendar of India is based on the Saka era, the first month of which is Chaitra. It was adopted on 22 March, 1957.